🖥️ Best Idle Passive Income Setup

Intel i9-12900K + NVIDIA RTX 3080 Ti

Comprehensive Analysis & Recommendations

⚡ Quick Verdict

Skip crypto mining — it's unprofitable at standard electricity rates. **Rent your GPU instead** for 10-50x better returns with less hardware stress.

📊 RTX 3080 Ti Mining Profitability

Current mining profitability at **$0.10/kWh electricity**:

Coin	Algorithm	Revenue/Day	Profit/Day
Vecno (VE)	MemHash	$0.35	-$0.02
Conflux (CFX)	Octopus	$0.62	-$0.19
Grin (GRIN)	Cuckatoo32	$0.51	-$0.25
Ethereum Classic	Etchash	$0.06	-$0.62

💡 **Reality Check:** Your RTX 3080 Ti draws 300-350W while mining. At $0.10/kWh, electricity costs ($0.37-$0.84/day) exceed revenue for nearly all coins.

Source: WhatToMine and Hashrate.no — live data as of 2025

🧠 i9-12900K CPU Mining

CPU mining profitability (RandomX algorithm):

Platform/Coin	Hashrate	Power	Profit/Day
Quantum (QRL)	11.6 Kh/s	125W	$0.03
NiceHash	11.6 Kh/s	125W	$0.03
Monero (XMR)	11.6 Kh/s	125W	-$0.01

Verdict: Not worth the electricity and hardware wear. Your CPU earns less than a cup of coffee per month.

🏆 GPU Rental Platforms (Recommended)

Rent your GPU for AI/ML workloads when idle — much more profitable than mining:

#1 Pick

Salad Cloud

$15-45/mo

- Windows app, easy setup
- Pause/resume anytime
- Gift cards, PayPal, crypto
- 60K+ daily active GPUs

#2 Pick

Vast.ai

$15-60+/mo

- RTX 3080 Ti: $0.09/hr median
- Linux required
- Weekly payouts
- Set your own prices

#3 Pick

Clore.ai

$6-15/mo

- CLORE token rewards
- 15% APY staking
- Docker-based
- 4,500+ active GPUs

> **Note:** Earnings vary based on demand and utilization. Real-world reports show $0.50-$2/day on Vast.ai when rented, but expect idle periods.

📈 Comparison: All Methods

Method	Daily	Monthly	Setup	Risk
❌ GPU Mining	-$0.02	-$0.60	Easy	High (wear)
❌ CPU Mining	$0.03	$0.90	Easy	Medium
✅ Salad Cloud	$0.50-1.50	$15-45	Very Easy	Low
✅ Vast.ai	$0.50-2.00	$15-60	Medium	Low
✅ Clore.ai	$0.20-0.50	$6-15	Easy	Token vol.

🎯 Our Recommendation

Option 1: Maximum Earnings (Best for Most Users)

Platform: Salad Cloud
Why: Easiest setup, runs on Windows, pause anytime, steady demand
Expected: $15-45/month with minimal effort

Option 2: Power User Setup

Platform: Vast.ai
Why: Higher rates, but requires Linux and dedicated setup
Expected: $15-60+/month (varies with demand)

Option 3: Only If You Have Free Electricity

Activity: Mine Vecno (VE) or use NiceHash
Requirement: Electricity cost <$0.05/kWh (solar, dorm, etc.)
Expected: Break-even to $0.20/day

⚙️ Quick Setup Guide

For Salad Cloud (Easiest):

1. Download Salad from salad.com
2. Create account and verify
3. Install the app on your Windows PC
4. Let it run when PC is idle
5. Cash out to PayPal, crypto, or gift cards

For Vast.ai (Higher Earnings):

1. Set up a Linux machine (Ubuntu recommended)
2. Install NVIDIA drivers and Docker

3. Create host account at vast.ai
4. List your RTX 3080 Ti at competitive rates ($0.08-0.12/hr)
5. Monitor utilization and adjust pricing

📚 Sources

1. WhatToMine - RTX 3080 Ti Calculator
2. Hashrate.no - RTX 3080 Ti Hashrates
3. Hashrate.no - i9-12900K Hashrates
4. Salad Cloud
5. Clore.ai Hosting
6. NiceHash Profitability Calculator
7. Vast.ai Pricing
8. 2CryptoCalc - GPU Comparison